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Temperature gradient control with thermal interface material variation

Abstract

A battery module and a method of assembling the battery module are provided. The battery module includes a cooling surface having a first area and a second area with different cooling capacities, an adhesive including a first component having a first thermal conductivity and a second component having a second thermal conductivity, and a first battery and a second battery. The first battery is secured to the first area by a first portion of the adhesive and the second battery is secured to the second area by a second portion the adhesive. The first portion of the adhesive has a first ratio of the first component to the second component and the second portion of the adhesive has a second ratio of the first component to the second component. The first and second ratios are different and compensate for the different cooling capacities of the first and second areas.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/026,919, filed Sep. 21, 2020, the disclosure which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

SUMMARY

(1) It is advantageous to package battery cells closely in high-voltage, large-format battery modules to provide high energy density battery modules. To provide a high energy density battery module, cylindrical battery cells may be arranged with a bottom end of each of the battery cells secured to a cooling surface of the battery module using an adhesive. However, in such battery modules, the thermal gradient across the plurality of battery cells in the battery module needs to be effectively controlled so that all of the battery cells are equally cooled.

(2) Thus, it is advantageous for the cooling capacity of the cooling surface to be uniform across the cooling surface. If the cooling capacity of the cooling surface varies across the cooling surface and the thermal gradient across the plurality of battery cells is not effectively controlled, certain battery cells will be cooled less than other battery cells in the battery module and will degrade faster than the other battery cells, resulting in accelerated capacity loss of the overall battery module.

Additionally, if the thermal gradient across the plurality of battery cells is not effectively controlled, it may be difficult to estimate the temperature of each of the battery cells in the battery module during operation (e.g., by measuring the temperature of select battery cells and estimating the temperature of the other battery cells based on the measured temperatures) without directly measuring the temperature of each of the battery cells.

(3) These problems may be particularly relevant to large format battery modules having several arrays of battery cells electrically connected in parallel groups because temperature sensors for many or all of the battery cells may add cost and complexity, and because the capacity loss of a single battery cell in a parallel group of battery cells may be propagated to all the battery cells in the parallel group of battery cells, thereby significantly lowering the capacity of the battery module.

(4) To solve these problems, systems and methods are provided herein for efficiently controlling the thermal gradient across a plurality of battery cells in a battery module (e.g., a high energy density battery module). To accomplish this, a battery module and a method of assembling the battery module are provided. The battery module includes a cooling surface including a first area and a second area each having a different cooling capacity, an adhesive including a first component having a first thermal conductivity and a second component having a second thermal conductivity, and a first battery and a second battery. A first end of the first battery is secured to the first area by a first portion of the adhesive and a first end of the second battery is secured to the second area by a second portion the adhesive. The first portion of the adhesive has a first ratio of the first component to the second component and the second portion of the adhesive has a second ratio of the first component to the second component. The first ratio and the second ratio are different and compensate for the different cooling capacities of the first area and the second area.

(5) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the first component and the second component may be a resin, and the adhesive may further include a hardener.

(6) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the battery module may further include a cooling plate. The cooling surface may form a first side of the cooling plate.

(7) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling plate may further include an input port, an output port, and a cooling channel. Cooling fluid may pass from the input port to the output port through the cooling channel.

(8) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first area may have a first cooling capacity and the second area has a second cooling capacity, the first cooling capacity may be greater than

the second cooling capacity, the first thermal conductivity may be greater than the second thermal conductivity, the first ratio of the first component to the second component may be greater than the second ratio of the first component to the second component, and the first ratio and the second ratio may compensate for the difference between the first cooling capacity and the second cooling capacity such that the first battery and the second battery may be provided with the same cooling capacity.

(9) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first thermal conductivity may be greater than or equal to 1.0 Watts/meter*Kelvin (W/m*K), and the second thermal conductivity may be less than or equal to 0.3 W/m*K.

(10) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the adhesive may further include a plurality of beads for spacing the first end of each of the first battery and the second battery a predetermined distance from the cooling surface.

(11) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling surface may be a first cooling surface, and the battery module may further include a second cooling surface, opposite to the first cooling surface. The second cooling surface may include a third area and a fourth area, and the third area and the fourth area may have different cooling capacities. The battery module may further include a third battery and a fourth battery. A first end of the third battery may be secured to the third area by a third portion of the adhesive, a first end of the fourth battery may be secured to the fourth area by a fourth portion the adhesive, the third portion may have a third ratio of the first component to the second component and the second portion may have a fourth ratio of the first component to the second component, and the third ratio and the fourth ratio may be different and may compensate for the different cooling capacities of the third area and the fourth area such that the third battery and the fourth battery may be provided with similar cooling capacity.

(12) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first ratio may be an average ratio of the first component to the second component of the first portion, and a ratio of the first component to the second component of the first portion may vary within the first area.

(13) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first ratio may be consistent within the first portion.

(14) In some embodiments, a method of assembling a battery module is provided. The method includes providing a cooling surface with a cooling capacity that varies across the cooling surface, providing an adhesive including a first component having a first thermal conductivity to a second component having a second thermal conductivity, providing a first battery and a second battery, applying the adhesive with a first ratio of the first component to the second component to a first area of the cooling surface, applying the adhesive with a second ratio of the first component to the second component to a second area of the cooling surface, securing a first end of the first battery to the first area using the adhesive applied to the first area, and securing a first end of the second battery to the second area using the adhesive applied to the second area. The first ratio and the second ratio are different and compensate for the different cooling capacities of the first area and the second area.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The above and other objects and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent upon consideration of the following detailed description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which like reference characters refer to like parts throughout, and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 shows a view of a battery module, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 shows a top view of a planned arrangement of battery cells on a first cooling surface of a

cooling plate, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3A shows a cross-sectional view through the center of an illustrative cooling plate, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(5) FIG. 3B shows an adhesive having varied thermal conductivity applied to the first cooling surface of the illustrative cooling plate, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(6) FIG. 4 shows a view of a battery module, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(7) FIG. 5 shows a block diagram of an apparatus for mixing and disposing an adhesive on the first cooling surface of the cooling plate, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure; and

(8) FIG. 6 shows a flowchart of a process for manufacturing a battery module, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) In view of the foregoing, and in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, it would be advantageous to provide and easily manufacture a battery module with a high energy density that efficiently controls the thermal gradient across the plurality of battery cells in the battery module. In some embodiments, the battery module provided herein may use any cooling surface for providing uniform cooling, including a cooling surface of a cooling plate using liquid cooling. To do this, the battery module described herein may use an adhesive (e.g., a thermal interface material) with a variable thermal coefficient to secure each of the battery cells in the battery module to a cooling surface. By varying the thermal coefficient of the adhesive based on a cooling profile of the cooling surface, the adhesive may compensate for any differences in cooling capacity across the cooling surface, thereby ensuring uniform cooling (or heating) of all of the battery cells in the battery module.

(10) FIG. 1 shows a view of a battery module **100**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown, the battery module **100** includes a plurality of battery cells **102**. Each of the battery cells **102** may be cylindrical and may have a first end **104** comprising a first electrical terminal and a second end **106** having a second electrical terminal **107** (e.g., a center button terminal). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the battery cells **102** may have an exposed region of electrically-active casing or a conductive jacket that covers at least a portion of the first end **104** and a side of each battery cell **102**, forming the first electrical terminal. To increase packing density, the battery cells **102** may be arranged in rows that are offset from each other (e.g., in a hexagonal close-packed arrangement). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, each adjacent pair of the battery cells **102** may be 1.5 mm apart or less. Groups of the battery cells **102** may be electrically connected in series or parallel using one or more busbars (not shown for simplicity). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, several battery cells **102** may be connected in parallel to form a subgroup, and a plurality of subgroups may be connected in series. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the plurality of subgroups may be voltage balanced against each other. It should be understood that there may be any suitable number of the battery cells **102**.

(11) The battery module **100** may further include a thermal transfer plate, e.g., a cooling plate **110**, as shown. The cooling plate **110** may have a first cooling surface **112**. As shown, the first end **104** of each of battery cells **102** may be secured to the first cooling surface **112** by an adhesive **108**. As described in greater detail below, the adhesive **108** may be an adhesive with a variable heat transfer coefficient. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling plate **110** may be used to selectively cool (or heat) the battery cells **102**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling plate **110** may have one or more channels for cooling/heating fluid to travel through, as described in greater detail below with reference to FIG. 3A. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling plate **110** may be composed of an electrically conductive material (e.g., a

metal such as aluminum). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, in order to reduce the likelihood of an electrical short between the battery cells **102** and the first cooling surface **112**, the first cooling surface **112** may comprise a dielectric coating. The cooling plate **110** may have a second cooling surface **114**, opposite to the first cooling surface **112**, which may also comprise a dielectric coating.

(12) FIG. 2 shows a top view of a planned arrangement of the battery cells **102** on the first cooling surface **112** of the cooling plate **110**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. For convenience of description, a planned arrangement of four rows of five battery cells **102** per row is shown. However, it should be understood that there may be any suitable number of the battery cells **102** in any arrangement. As shown, the planned arrangement of the battery cells **102** may be within a battery mounting region **202** of the first cooling surface **112**.

(13) Before the battery cells **102** are secured to the first cooling surface **112**, a cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may be determined. The cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** refers to a cooling capacity provided at each point or localized area across the first cooling surface **112**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** includes the entire area within the battery mounting region **202**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** includes only the portions of the first cooling surface **112** corresponding to the planned placement of each of the battery cells **102** (i.e., **112a**, **112b**, **112c**, **112d**, **112e**, . . . **112n**).

(14) The cooling capacity at each point across the first cooling surface **112** may vary based on a number of factors including, for example, the proximity to an edge of the cooling plate **110**, the proximity to a cooling channel (e.g., alignment/misalignment with the cooling channel), and the temperature of cooling fluid in the cooling channel, the proximity to other devices mounted on the first cooling surface **112**, and any other factors that affect the cooling capacity. For example, the thickness of the overall stack between the bottom of battery cell **102** mounted on the first cooling surface **112** and the cooling fluid in the cooling channel may also affect the cooling capacity. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may be determined by experimentation. For example, the cooling capacity at each point across the first cooling surface **112** may be measured. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may be estimated by modeling the first cooling surface **112**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may be determined in advance and stored in a memory.

(15) The resolution of the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may vary based on the particular application. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, as explained in greater detail below, the resolution of the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may correspond to the resolution at which the thermal coefficient of the adhesive can be changed (e.g., 1 mm). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, to determine the cooling profile, the cooling capacity of each portion (e.g., 1 mm×1 mm) of the first cooling surface **112** may be determined. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may include the average cooling capacity of each of the portions of the first cooling surface **112** corresponding to the planned placements of the battery cells **102** (i.e., **112a**, **112b**, **112c**, **112d**, **112e**, . . . **112n**). It should be understood that the resolution of the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may be any resolution.

(16) FIG. 3A shows a cross-sectional view through the center of an illustrative cooling plate **300**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. A first region **302** may correspond to an input port of the cooling plate **300**, while a second region **304** may correspond to an output port of the cooling plate **300**. The first region **302** and the second region **304** may be connected by a channel **306**. Cooling fluid may enter the cooling plate **300** at the input port, by region **302**, and travel along the channel **306**, before reaching the second region **304** and exiting the cooling plate **300** through the output port (i.e., in the direction indicated by the arrows). As the cooling fluid

travels through the cooling plate **300**, the cooling fluid absorbs heat and becomes warmer. Accordingly, even if the arrangement of the channel **306** is optimized for a planned arrangement of the battery cells **102**, the cooling profile of the cooling plate **300** may still vary across the cooling surface of the cooling plate **300**. For example, as shown, the cooling fluid flows through the channel **306** in a direction from the first planned battery cell placement **112a** to the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**. Thus, the battery cell **102** at the first planned battery cell placement **112a** may be provided with more cooling capacity than, e.g., the battery cell **102** at the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**. However, as set forth above, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may vary based on other factors (e.g., distance to an edge, proximity to other batteries, electrical elements, etc.).

(17) Returning to FIG. **1**, the first end **104** of the battery cells **102** may be secured to the first cooling surface **112** by the adhesive **108**. The electrical, thermal, and mechanical properties of the adhesive **108** of the present disclosure may correspond to the engineering and manufacturing requirements associated with the battery module **100**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the adhesive **108** may be a thermal interface material having a thermal conductivity that can be varied. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the adhesive **108** may include at least two different components having different thermal conductivities. For example, the adhesive **108** may include at least two different resins (e.g., an epoxy resin, a polyester resin, an acrylic resin, etc.) and a curative (e.g., a hardener or an initiator). By varying the ratio of the two resin components in the adhesive **108**, the thermal conductivity of the adhesive **108** may be varied. Of course, this is only one example, and the adhesive may have more than two different resin components having different thermal conductivities. In some embodiments, the adhesive **108** may include a resin and at least two different curatives having different thermal conductivities.

(18) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first component of the adhesive (a first resin) may have a higher thermal conductivity than the second component of the adhesive (a second resin). For example, the first resin may have a thermal conductivity of 1.4 Watts/meter*Kelvin (W/m*K). However, this is only one example, and the first resin may have a thermal conductivity greater than or equal to 1.0 W/m*K. The second resin may have a thermal conductivity of 0.1 W/m*K. However, this is only one example, and the second resin may have a thermal conductive less than or equal to 0.3 W/m*K.

(19) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the ratio of the first resin to the second resin in the adhesive **108** may be varied based on the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112**. By varying the ratio of the first to the second resin in the adhesive **108** based on the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112**, the adhesive **108** may compensate for variabilities in the cooling capacity across the first cooling surface **112** and provide equal cooling to each of the battery cells **102** mounted thereon. For example, the first resin has a thermal conductivity of 1.0 W/m*K and the second resin has a thermal conductivity of 0.3 W/m*K, the thermal conductivity of the adhesive **108** may be varied from 0.3 W/m*K–1.0 W/m*K by varying the ratio of the first resin to the second resin from 0/100 to 100/0.

(20) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the thermal conductivities of the first and second resins may be varied by doping with standard additives that are thermally conductive but electrically insulative such as alumina, boron nitride, alumina trihydrate, or magnesium hydroxide, where the latter two materials may impart added flame retardancy properties to the mixed adhesive at the cost of reduced thermal conductivity to weight ratio. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the second resin may have its viscoelastic properties modified to match that of the first resin by addition of additives with low thermal conductivities such as fumed silica or other thickeners to increase viscosity while still keeping the thermal conductivity low. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, it may be advantageous for the thermal conductivities of both of the first and second resins to be high in order to maximize the cooling provided by the first cooling surface **112**. For example, if the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** does not

include a large amount of variation across the first cooling surface **112**, the difference between the thermal conductivities of the first and second resins may be smaller than the entire range of possible thermal conductivities.

(21) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, in order to maximize the cooling provided by the first cooling surface **112**, the adhesive **108** having the highest possible thermal conductivity should be applied to the area of the first cooling surface **112** having the lowest cooling capacity conductivity (e.g., a ratio of 100/0 of the first resin to the second resin). In some embodiments of the present disclosure, based on, e.g., limitations of the ratios of the resins or the way in which they are applied, the ratio of the first resin to the second resin may be limited to a minimum amount of the first resin or the second resin (e.g., 10/90).

(22) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, it may be advantageous to maintain the uniformity of the thickness of the cured adhesive **108** so that the battery cells **102** are spaced apart from the first cooling surface **112** by a same distance. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the thickness of the adhesive **108** may be controlled by impregnating the adhesive with glass beads (or other materials) having a predetermined size. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the thickness of the adhesive **108** may be controlled by using pre-cured adhesive standoffs to maintain the uniform distance between each of the battery cells **102** and the first cooling surface **112** while the adhesive **108** cures. Aside from securing the battery cells **102** to the first cooling surface **112** and compensating for the variabilities in cooling capacity across the first cooling surface **112**, the adhesive **108** should also maintain electrical isolation between the battery cells **102** and the first cooling surface **112** and maintain electrical isolation between each parallel connected group of the battery cells **102**. Thus, the adhesive **108** should also have sufficient dielectric properties.

(23) FIG. 3B shows the adhesive **108** having varied thermal conductivity applied to the first cooling surface **112** of the illustrative cooling plate **300**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. To avoid overcomplicating the description, FIG. 3B shows the adhesive **108** only being applied to the first planned battery cell placement **112a** through the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**. However, it should be understood that the adhesive **108** is applied to all of the planned battery cell placements or the entire area within the battery mounting region **202**. As shown via different fill patterns, the ratio of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108** may be varied for each of the first planned battery cell placement **112a** through the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**, based on the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** may include an average cooling capacity of each of the first planned battery cell placement **112a** through the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**. In this case, a different ratio of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108** may be determined for each of the planned battery cell placements. For example, if the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112** indicates that the cooling capacity of the first cooling surface **112** slowly decreases from the first planned battery cell placement **112a** through the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e**, the ratio of the first resin (having a high thermal conductivity) to the second resin (having a low thermal conductivity) may slowly increase so that each of the battery cells **102** provided at the first planned battery cell placement **112a** through the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e** is equally cooled. Although, as shown, the first planned battery cell placement **112a** has a first ratio **108a** of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108**, the second planned battery cell placement **112b** has a second ratio **108b** of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108**, the third planned battery cell placement **112c** has a third ratio **108c** of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108**, the fourth planned battery cell placement **112d** has a fourth ratio **108d** of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108**, and the fifth planned battery cell placement **112e** has a fifth ratio **108e** of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108**, this is only an example, and the ratio of the first resin to the second resin of the adhesive **108** may gradually change across each of the planned

battery cell placements or the entire area within the battery mounting region **202**. After the adhesive **108** is applied to the first cooling surface **112**, the battery cells **102** may be disposed on the adhesive **108**.

(24) FIG. **4** shows a view of a battery module **400**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown, the battery module **400** corresponds to the battery module **100**, except that a plurality of battery cells **122** are provided on the second cooling surface **114**. The battery cells **122** may be provided in the same manner as described above with reference to the battery cells **102** and the first cooling surface **112**.

(25) FIG. **5** shows a block diagram of an apparatus **500** for mixing and dispensing the adhesive **108** on the first cooling surface **112** of the cooling plate **110**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. However, this is only one example and the apparatus **500** may alternatively (or additionally) dispense the adhesive **108** on the first end **104** of each of the battery cells **102**. Although the apparatus **500** may dispense the adhesive **108** on the second cooling surface **114** of the cooling plate **110** (and/or the end of each of the battery cells **122**), only the first cooling surface **112** is discussed herein to avoid overcomplicating the description. As shown, the apparatus **500** may include a controller **501** and an adhesive dispersal module **503** connected to the controller. Although the controller **501** and the adhesive dispersal module **503** are shown as separate devices (e.g., wired or wirelessly connected), the controller **501** and the adhesive dispersal module **503** may be included in the same device.

(26) The controller **501** may include control circuitry **502** that includes a storage **504** and processing circuitry **506**, and an input/output (I/O) path **508**. The controller **501** may receive content and data via the I/O path **508**. For example, cooling profiles and planned arrangements of battery cells may be received via the I/O path **508**.

(27) The control circuitry **502** may be based on any suitable processing circuitry such as the processing circuitry **506**. As referred to herein, processing circuitry should be understood to mean circuitry based on one or more microprocessors, microcontrollers, digital signal processors, programmable logic devices, field-programmable gate arrays, application-specific integrated circuits, etc. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the control circuitry **502** executes instructions stored in memory (i.e., the storage **504**) for controlling various portions of the apparatus **500** to perform the functions discussed above and below. For example, the control circuitry **502** executes instructions to control the adhesive dispersal module **503**.

(28) The adhesive dispersal module **503** applies the adhesive **108** on the first cooling surface **112** of the cooling plate **110**. As shown, the adhesive dispersal module **503** may include a first resin **510**, a second resin **512**, and a hardener **514**. Based on the cooling profile of the first cooling surface **112**, the control circuitry **502** may control the mixing module **516** to mix varying ratios of the first resin **510** and the second resin **512** with the hardener **514** to compensate for the variable cooling capacity of the cooling surface. The control circuitry **502** may control the positioning motor **522** to change the location of the nozzle **518** for applying the mixed adhesive **108** to the first cooling surface **112**. Although only a single nozzle **518** is shown, this is only an example and the nozzle **518** may contain multiple nozzles. For example, the mixing module **516** may contain multiple mixing modules for separately mixing the first resin **510** with the hardener **514** and the second resin **512** with the hardener **514**. The separately mixed resins **510** and **512** may then be applied to the first cooling surface **112** through separate nozzles. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the first resin **510**, the second resin **512**, and the hardener **514** may be mixed in the nozzle **518**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the nozzle **518** may include a three-way mixing head, three separate mix heads, or two mix heads for disposing the first resin **510**, the second resin **512**, and the hardener **514** on the first cooling surface **112**.

(29) The positioning motor **522** may contain any number of motors (e.g., servos, stepper motors, etc.) for adjusting the position of the nozzle **518** with respect to the first cooling surface **112**. The positioning motor **522** may be controlled by control circuitry **502**.

(30) The adhesive dispersal module **503** may additionally include sensors **520** (e.g., a camera or any other suitable sensor) to track the dispersal of the adhesive **108** on the first cooling surface **112**, or to meter the amounts of the first resin **510**, the second resin **512**, and hardener **514** provided to the mixing module **516**. The output of sensors **520** may be provided to controller **501**, which may use the output to control the operation of the adhesive dispersal module **503**.

(31) FIG. **6** shows a flowchart of an illustrative process **600** for manufacturing a battery module **100**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. To avoid overcomplicating the description, process **600** is described with respect to only two battery cells **102** in the battery module **100**. However, it should be understood that the process **600** may be used for manufacturing the battery module **100** (or the battery module **400**) with any suitable number of the battery cells **102**.

(32) At step **602**, a cooling surface is provided. The cooling surface may be the first cooling surface **112** of the cooling plate **110**, as described above.

(33) At step **604**, a cooling profile of the cooling surface may be determined. As detailed above, the cooling profile may be determined by experimentation (e.g., by measuring the cooling capacity across the cooling surface) or by modeling the cooling profile of the cooling surface. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the cooling profile may be retrieved from a database (e.g., by the controller **501** through the I/O path **508**).

(34) At step **606**, ratios of a first resin having a first thermal coefficient to a second resin having a second thermal coefficient of an adhesive (e.g., the adhesive **108**) to compensate for the differences in the cooling capacity at first and second areas of the cooling surface may be determined based on the cooling profile. (e.g., where the plurality of battery cells will be disposed) is determined. For example, the control circuitry **502** may determine the ratios based on the cooling profile of the cooling surface.

(35) At step **608**, the adhesive may be provided at the first and second areas of the cooling surface at the determined ratios to compensate for the differences in cooling capacity between the first and second areas. For example, the controller **501** may control the adhesive dispersal module **503** to provide the adhesive at the first and second areas at the determined ratios. As described above, the ratio (of the first resin to the second resin) of the adhesive provided at an area (e.g., the first or the second area) may have a same ratio for the entire area or a ratio that varies across the area.

(36) At step **610**, a first battery cell and a second battery cell may be provided.

(37) At step **612**, first ends of the first and second battery cells may be secured to the cooling surface by the adhesive. For example, the first end of the first battery cell may be secured to the first area by the adhesive having a first ratio of the first resin to the second resin, and the first end of the second battery cell may be secured to the second area by the adhesive having a second ratio of the first resin to the second resin, that is different from the first ratio. To secure the first and the second battery cells to the cooling surface, the first ends of the first and the second battery cells may be pressed into the adhesive before the adhesive cures.

(38) It will be understood that while process **600** was described in the context of manufacturing a battery module and securing battery cells to a cooling surface, process **600** may be used for securing any two components to a surfaces using an adhesive, where different thermal conductivity of the adhesive is desired.

(39) The foregoing is merely illustrative of the principles of this disclosure and various modifications may be made by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of this disclosure. The above described embodiments are presented for purposes of illustration and not of limitation. The present disclosure also can take many forms other than those explicitly described herein. Accordingly, it is emphasized that this disclosure is not limited to the explicitly disclosed methods, systems, and apparatuses, but is intended to include variations to and modifications thereof, which are within the spirit of the following claims.

Claims

1. A system comprising: a cooling surface comprising a first area and a second area; and an adhesive comprising: a plurality of beads comprising a predetermined size for maintaining a distance between a plurality of battery cells and the cooling surface; a first portion that secures an end of a first battery cell of the plurality of battery cells to the first area and comprises a first thermal conductivity; and a second portion that secures an end of a second battery cell of the plurality of battery cells to the second area and comprises a second thermal conductivity, different from the first thermal conductivity.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the predetermined size corresponds to the distance between the plurality of battery cells and the cooling surface.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the plurality of beads comprises glass.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the adhesive maintains an electrical isolation between the plurality of battery cells and the cooling surface.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein: the first area has a first cooling capacity and the second area of the cooling surface has a second cooling capacity; and a difference between the first thermal conductivity and the second thermal conductivity compensates for a difference between the first cooling capacity and the second cooling capacity.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein: the first area has a cooling capacity greater than the second area; the first portion comprises a first ratio of a first component to a second component; the second portion comprises a second ratio of the first component to the second component, the first component has a third thermal conductivity and the second component has a fourth thermal conductivity, the third thermal conductivity being greater than the fourth thermal conductivity; and the first ratio of the first component to the second component is greater than the second ratio of the first component to the second component.
7. The system of claim 6, wherein: the third thermal conductivity is greater than or equal to 1.0 Watts/meter*Kelvin ($\text{W/m}^*\text{K}$); and the fourth thermal conductivity is less than or equal to 0.3 $\text{W/m}^*\text{K}$.
8. The system of claim 6, wherein: each of the first component and the second component is a resin; and the adhesive further comprises a hardener.
9. A battery pack comprising: a cooling surface comprising a first area and a second area; and an adhesive that maintains an electrical isolation between a plurality of battery cells and the cooling surface, wherein the adhesive comprises: a first portion comprising a first thermal conductivity and that secures an end of a first battery cell of the plurality of battery cells to the first area; a second portion comprising a second thermal conductivity, different from the first thermal conductivity, and that secures an end of a second battery cell of the plurality of battery cells to the second area; and glass beads with a predetermined size that spaces ends of the plurality of battery cells from the cooling surface by a distance.
10. The battery pack of claim 9, wherein the glass beads comprise glass.
11. A method comprising: impregnating an adhesive with beads having a predetermined size for maintaining a predetermined distance between a plurality of battery cells and a cooling surface; providing the adhesive between the cooling surface and the plurality of battery cells; securing an end of a first battery cell, of the plurality of battery cells, to a first area of the cooling surface by a first portion of the adhesive comprising a first thermal conductivity; and securing an end of a second battery cell, of the plurality of battery cells, to a second area of the cooling surface by a second portion of the adhesive comprising a second thermal conductivity, different from the first thermal conductivity; and curing the adhesive to space the plurality of battery cells from the cooling surface by the predetermined distance.
12. The method of claim 11, further comprising maintaining electrical isolation between the

plurality of battery cells and the cooling surface.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein: the predetermined size corresponds to the predetermined distance; and the beads comprise glass.

14. The method of claim 11, further comprising providing a cooling plate comprising an input port, an output port, and a cooling channel, wherein the cooling surface forms a first side of the cooling plate, and wherein a cooling capacity of the cooling surface varies across the cooling surface.

15. The method of claim 11, wherein: the first area and the second area of the cooling surface have different cooling capacities; and the first thermal conductivity and the second thermal conductivity compensate for a difference in cooling capacities of the first area and the second area.

16. The method of claim 11, further comprising: determining a cooling profile of the cooling surface, wherein the cooling profile comprises a cooling capacity provided at each point across the cooling surface; determining a first cooling capacity provided at the first area of the cooling surface based on the cooling profile; and determining a second cooling capacity provided at the second area of the cooling surface based on the cooling profile, wherein the first thermal conductivity and the second thermal conductivity compensate for a difference between the first cooling capacity and the second cooling capacity such that the first battery cell and the second battery cell are provided with a same cooling capacity.
